Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-11-05

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Amos 2:1-8

1 Thus says the Lord: "For three transgressions of Moab, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment, because he burned the bones of the king of Edom to lime.

2 But I will send a fire upon Moab, and it shall devour the palaces of Kerioth; Moab shall die with tumult, with shouting and trumpet sound.

3 And I will cut off the judge from its midst, and slay all its princes with him," says the Lord.

4 Thus says the Lord: "For three transgressions of Judah, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment, because they have despised the law of the Lord, and have not kept His commandments. Their lies lead them astray, lies which their fathers followed.

5 But I will send a fire upon Judah, and it shall devour the palaces of Jerusalem."

6 Thus says the Lord: "For three transgressions of Israel, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment, because they sell the righteous for silver, and the poor for a pair of sandals.

7 They pant after the dust of the earth which is on the head of the poor, and pervert the way of the humble. A man and his father go in to the same girl, to defile My holy name.

8 They lie down by every altar on clothes taken in pledge, and drink the wine of the condemned in the house of their god."

II. Key Summary

• Moab has committed three transgressions, and four, because he burned the bones of the king of Edom to lime; the Lord will send a fire upon Moab, devour the palaces of Kerioth, and cut off its judge and all its princes (vv. 1–3).

• Judah has committed three transgressions, and four, because they despised the law of the Lord, did not keep His commandments, and were led astray by the lies their fathers followed; the Lord will send a fire upon Judah and devour the palaces of Jerusalem (vv. 4–5).

• Israel has committed three transgressions, and four, and the Lord will not turn away its punishment: they sell the righteous for silver and the poor for a pair of sandals, pervert the way of the humble, lie down by every altar on clothes taken in pledge, and drink the wine of the condemned in the house of their god (vv. 6–8).

III. Passage Analysis

The Sudden Turn

> The prophet announces judgment on Israel's enemies, moving from far to near. At first the Israelite listeners must have been delighted, rejoicing and cheering loudly; but then the prophet suddenly turns, and turns to Israel's own sins. [1]

Verses 1, 4, and 6 use the same line, "For three transgressions ⋯ and for four, I will not turn away its punishment": after Moab comes Judah, and after Judah comes Israel.

This circle of judgment finally comes to rest on the people Amos saw these words "concerning" (1:1).

Throw Away the True, Grab Hold of the False

> Since the word of God brings us truth, when we despise and disobey God's word we naturally embrace and follow lies. You can't reject the truth without grabbing hold of a lie. [2]

Verse 4 has an order: first "they have despised the law of the LORD, and have not kept His commandments," then "their lies lead them astray, lies which their fathers followed."

Once they left God's word, what filled the space was "lies," and it had started with the generation before them.

Note: When did these things happen?

• Moab burned the bones of the king of Edom (v. 1): This event is not recorded in the historical books. It is often linked to 2 Kings 3:26: when Israel, Judah, and Edom joined to attack Moab, the king of Moab "took with him seven hundred men who drew swords, to break through to the king of Edom, but they could not." [3][4]

• Judah despised the law of the LORD (v. 4): When Amos spoke, the king of Judah was

Uzziah (1:1). Uzziah had restored true worship, but the hearts of the nation seem to have grown numb, used to going through the motions of worship. [1]

- Israel sold the righteous (v. 6): Jeroboam II "restored the territory of Israel from the entrance of Hamath to the Sea of the Arabah" (2 Kings 14:25), and the nation grew rich; but the wealth led to social apathy, injustice, and neglect of the poor. [5]
- Afterward:
  - Moab: Conquered by Tiglath-pileser III of Assyria. [1]
  - Judah: In 586 B.C., Nebuchadnezzar's army burned Jerusalem. [1][6]
  - Israel: About 40 years after Amos, Assyria attacked Israel and carried the people away (2 Kings 17). [5]

IV. Reflection Question

Have you ever had this happen: while you were still feeling smug as someone else's faults were pointed out, before long it was your turn to be rebuked?

Israel listened as Moab and Judah were named, and at first they must have been cheering [1]; then the same line, "For three transgressions ⋯ and for four, I will not turn away its punishment," was given Israel's own name (v. 6) [7].

References

[1] 華人基督徒查經資料網站 (Chinese Christian Bible Study), Amos 2 notes (Tsai Che-min, study notes; Ryrie Study Bible notes), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/30Amos/30GT02.htm

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik (Amos 2:4), https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/amos-2/

[3] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry Commentary (Amos 2), https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/Amo/Amo_002.cfm

[4] BibleHub, Barnes' Notes on the Bible; Cambridge Bible; Jamieson-Fausset-Brown (Amos 2:1), https://biblehub.com/commentaries/amos/2-1.htm

[5] BibleProject, Book of Amos guide, https://bibleproject.com/guides/book-of-amos/

[6] BibleHub, Benson Commentary (Amos 2:4),

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[7] BibleHub, Barnes' Notes on the Bible (Amos 1:3),
https://biblehub.com/commentaries/amos/1-3.htm